Ajeenkya D.Y Patil University

School of Engineering

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A

Project Report

On

"User Validation System"

Submitted By:

Name of Student	URN No.
Khilari Tejas Dattatray	2024-B-24112002

IN PARTIAL FULFILLMENT OF

BCA

Ajeenkya D Y Patil School of Engineering

Lohegaon , Pune 412105

Ajeenkya D.Y Patil University

School of Engineering

2024-2025

Certificate

This is to certify that**, Khilari Tejas Dattatray,** Having URN **2024-B-24112002** student of BCA Semester III has successfully / partially completed a Program file of **Summer Project Evaluation** in partial fulfilment of BCA under Ajeenkya D.Y Patil University, for the academic year 2024-2025.

Prof. Ritik Gupta **Prof.Devyani Kamble**

Internal Guide Program Coordinator

Date: 21/11/2025

Internal Examiner: External Examiner:

1. _____ 2. _____

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Project Overview

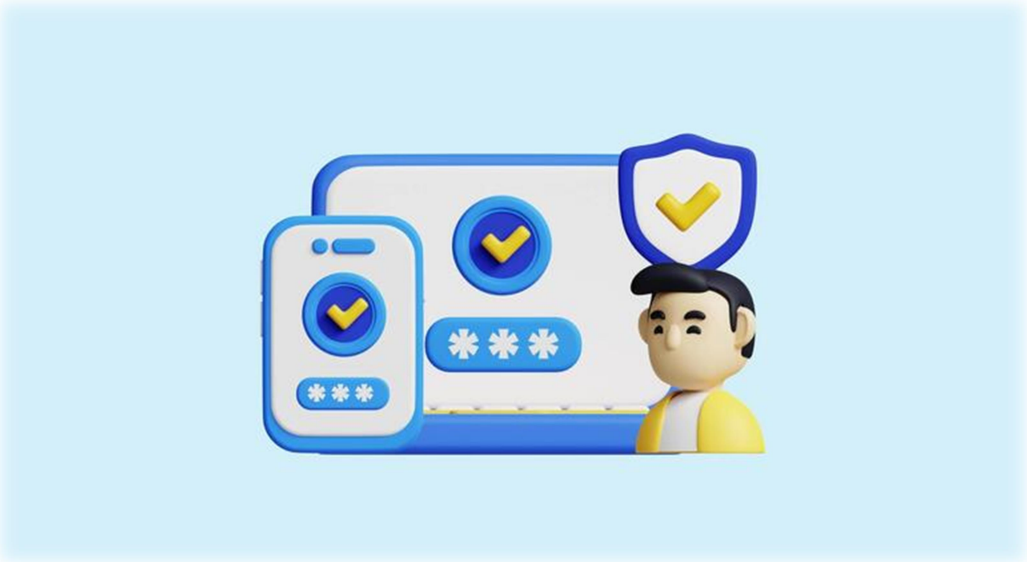
- **Project Title**:
  User Validation System

- **Project Type**
  Full-stack (Frontend + Backend)

- **Short-Description**
  A user validation system that allows users to securely register, log in, and access protected resources. It utilizes frontend forms for input and backend logic to verify user credentials and manage sessions.

- **Purpose**
  To provide a secure authentication mechanism that ensures only authorized users can access specific parts of the application, enhancing data privacy and user experience.

- **Problem-Statement**
  Many applications lack robust user validation, leading to unauthorized access and data breaches. This project aims to fill that gap by implementing a secure, reliable user authentication system.



Project Objectives

- **Development Objectives**

The aim to build a secure and functional user validation system that covers the entire user authentication lifecycle. This includes user registration, login, password recovery, and secure session management. The system will verify user identities to control access to protected resources and prevent unauthorized entry. The project also focuses on usability, ensuring clear user feedback and input validation to minimize errors and enhance user experience.

- **Technical Objectives**

The project is designed to help master key web development technologies and security concepts. This includes frontend skills with HTML, CSS, and JavaScript, and backend technologies such as Node.js or PHP with Express. Additionally, students will learn to implement password hashing using bcrypt or similar libraries to securely store passwords. Concepts like session management, cookies, token-based authentication (e.g., JWT), and input validation will be practiced. Attention to security best practices such as preventing SQL injection, Cross-Site Scripting (XSS), and Cross-Site Request Forgery (CSRF) will be emphasized.

- **Learning Outcomes**

Upon completion, students will have enhanced skills in full-stack web development, particularly in implementing authentication systems. They will understand security principles behind password management and data protection. The experience gained will include designing secure user flows, writing backend API endpoints, managing user sessions securely, and validating inputs both client- and server-side. They will also understand important compliance aspects like GDPR related to user data protection and be prepared to implement multi-factor authentication and other advanced security features in future projects.

- **Key Features**

  - User Registration: Secure form with input validation that lets users create accounts.
  - Login System: Password authentication with hashed password verification.
  - Password Recovery: Mechanism for users to reset forgotten passwords securely.
  - Session Management: Persistent login sessions with timeout and logout features to protect sessions.
  - Access Control: Restricts access to certain pages or resources only to authenticated users.

Project Scope

Functional Coverage

- User account creation with validation.
- Secure login and password verification.
- Session management with login persistence and timeout.
- Password reset via secure confirmation (e.g., email token).
- Access control to restrict unauthorized access to protected areas.
- Input validation and security measures to prevent attacks like XSS and CSRF.

Technology Stack to Be Used

- Frontend: HTML5, CSS3 for styling, JavaScript for client-side logic and validation.
- Backend: Node.js with Express.js or PHP for server-side processing.

Authentication Libraries:

- bcrypt for hashing passwords, express-session or JWT for session management.
- Database: MongoDB, MySQL, or PostgreSQL to store user data securely.

Technology Stack

1. **Frontend Technologies**

- HTML: Structure and content of web pages.
- CSS: Styling and layout customization.
- JavaScript: Interactivity and client-side validation.
- Bootstrap / Tailwind CSS: Frameworks for responsive and modern UI design.
- React / Angular (optional): For building dynamic single-page applications with component-based architecture.

2. **Backend Technologies**

- Python + Flask / Django: Lightweight or full-featured frameworks for server-side logic, APIs, and authentication.
- PHP: For server-side scripting, forms processing, and database interactions.
- Node.js + Express: JavaScript runtime environment with a framework for scalable server-side development, ideal for RESTful APIs.

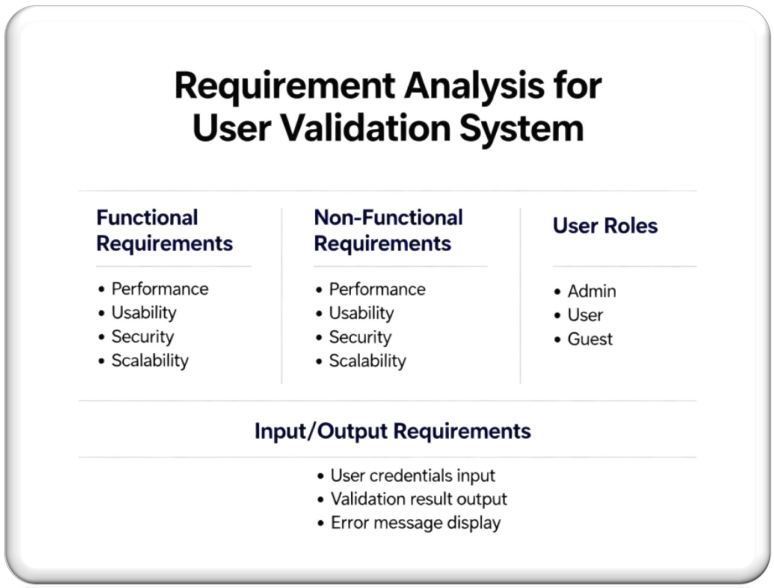
3. **Database Systems**

- MySQL: Relational database to store user credentials, session info.
- MongoDB: NoSQL database suitable for flexible data schemas, good for user profiles and sessions.

4. **Development Tools**

- VS Code: Popular code editor supporting multiple languages and extensions.
- Git / GitHub: Version control system for collaborative development.
- XAMPP / WAMP: Local server environments for PHP and database testing.
- Browser Developer Tools: For debugging and live testing frontend changes.
- Postman: API testing tool for backend verification.

Requirement analysis



1. **<u>Functional Requirements</u>**

- User registration functionality with validation for all input fields.
- Secure login mechanism to authenticate registered users.
- Password recovery/reset functionality via email or security questions.
- Session management to maintain user login state securely.
- Access control to restrict certain pages or features to authenticated users.
- Ability to log out and terminate sessions.
- Proper error handling and user feedback messages during all interactions.

2. **<u>Non-Functional Requirements</u>**

- Performance: The system should provide quick response times (<2 seconds) for user actions like login and registration, even under moderate load.
- Usability: The interface should be intuitive, responsive, and mobile-friendly, guiding users clearly through all processes.
- Security: Passwords must be hashed before storage; protection against common attacks such as SQL injection, XSS, and CSRF must be implemented. Secure transmission protocols (HTTPS) should be used.

- Scalability: The system should be designed to support growth in user base and transactions without significant performance degradation.

3. **User Roles**

Admin: (If applicable) Manages user accounts, views logs, and oversees system health.

Registered User: Can register, log in, access protected resources, reset passwords.

Guest: Can only access public pages and registration/login forms.

4. **Input / Output Requirements**

i) Inputs:

- User information fields such as username, email, and password on registration form.
- Login credentials submitted via login form.
- Email or security answers for password recovery.

ii) Outputs:

- Confirmation messages for successful registration and password changes.
- Error messages for validation failures or incorrect login credentials.
- Redirects to protected dashboards or error pages depending on authentication status.
- Session tokens or cookies to maintain user sessions securely.

System analysis

1. **Problem-Statement**

Many current applications suffer from insecure authentication methods that are prone to data breaches, unauthorized access, and poor user experience. There is a critical need for a reliable and secure user validation system to safeguard sensitive data and ensure that only authorized users gain access.

2. Existing System Analysis

a) Manual processes or rudimentary login forms are commonly used but lack security like encrypted password storage and session management.
b) Popular or legacy apps often have gaps such as vulnerability to SQL injection, weak password policies, or insecure session handling.
c) Many existing systems do not provide comprehensive password recovery or multi-layered security features.

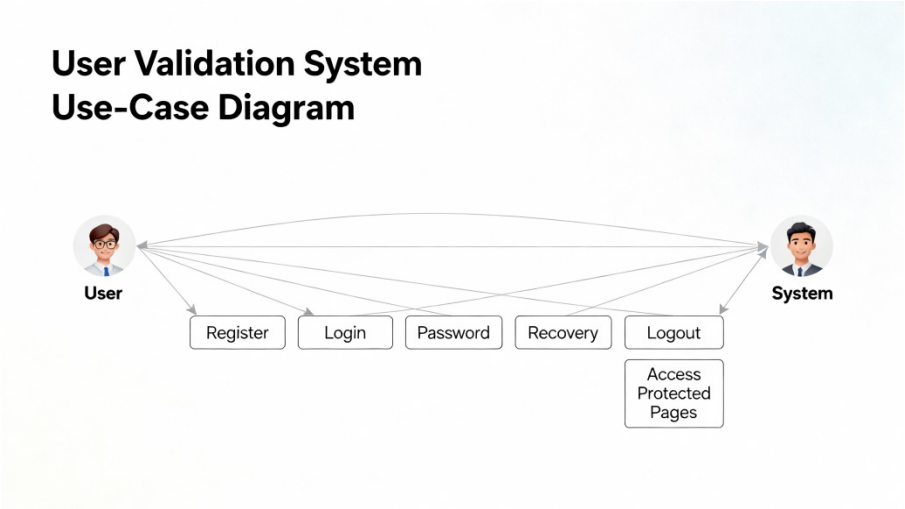
3. Proposed System

i. The proposed system offers a full-stack secure user validation process, including encrypted password storage, session management, and password recovery.
ii. It will feature comprehensive input validation, protection against common web attacks, and an intuitive user interface.
iii. This system improves over existing ones by integrating security best practices such as hashing, secure cookie usage, and access control.

4. Justification

i. The system is essential to protect user accounts and data privacy in the digital era.
ii. It ensures compliance with security standards and enhances user trust by providing robust authentication.
iii. By improving the authentication workflow and security, it reduces the risk of unauthorized access and potential data breaches.

5. Diagram –



Implementation Details

1. **Frontend Implementation**

   a) User Interface: Designed using HTML for structure, CSS for styling, and JavaScript for interactive behaviors such as real-time input validation and dynamic feedback messages.
   b) Responsive Design: CSS frameworks like Bootstrap or Tailwind were optionally used to achieve a responsive, modern look that works across devices.
   c) User Forms: Registration, login, and password recovery forms were implemented to capture user input securely and improve user experience.

2. **Backend Implementation**

   a) Server Environment: Node.js with Express.js framework was set up to handle HTTP requests from client-side forms.
   b) Password Security: User passwords were hashed with bcrypt before being stored in the MongoDB database to enhance data protection.
   c) Session Management: Used express-session to maintain secure user sessions and manage login states.
   d) API Endpoints: Created backend APIs for user registration, login authentication, password reset, and logout.

3. **Security Measures**

   - Input validation was implemented both client-side (JavaScript) and server-side (Node.js).
   - Protection against SQL injection, Cross-Site Scripting (XSS), and Cross-Site Request Forgery (CSRF) was considered.
   - Passwords were never stored in plain text; hashing ensured confidentiality.

Testing

Testing is a critical phase to ensure the user validation system works as expected, is secure, and user-friendly. The testing process for the frontend registration form included the following steps:

Stepwise Testing Process

1. **Input Validation Testing**

   Tested all input fields (username, email, password) with valid and invalid data to verify client-side validation triggers correctly.

   Example tests:

   Username less than 3 characters (should show error).

   Invalid email formats (missing "@" or ".").

   Password shorter than 6 characters.

   Verified that error messages appeared appropriately and form submission was prevented on invalid input.

2. **Functional Testing**

   Simulated successful user registrations by entering valid data.

   Confirmed that on successful validation an alert confirmed registration and the form was reset.

   Tested responsiveness of form on different browsers and device screen sizes.

3. **Boundary Testing**

   Checked edge cases for input lengths (e.g., username exactly 3 characters, passwords of minimum length).

   Verified the system's ability to handle these boundary inputs without failure.

4. **Usability Testing**

Assessed if error messages were clear and helped users correct inputs.

Ensured form focus and tab order were logical for accessibility.

5. **Negative Testing**

Entered malicious inputs (like scripts) to check for basic XSS prevention via frontend validation.

Tested rapid multiple submissions to check how the form handles bulk inputs (rate limiting would be managed backend).

6. Security Testing (Limited on Frontend)

Checked that passwords were not displayed or logged incorrectly.

Verified that password field hides input characters by default.

Testing Approaches Used

- Manual Testing: Most tests were done manually by entering various inputs and observing the form behavior, ideal for functional, boundary, and usability testing in frontend forms.
- Black Box Testing: Testing the system without internal knowledge, focusing on inputs and expected outputs (like error messages).
- Positive and Negative Testing: Tests included both valid (positive) inputs and invalid or malicious (negative) inputs.
- Exploratory Testing: Informal, ad-hoc testing to explore any unexpected behaviors or bugs via random input sequences.

Result

1. **Functional Outcomes**

   i. The system successfully allowed users to register with valid credentials while rejecting invalid inputs with clear error messages.
   ii. User login functionality authenticated registered users correctly and prevented access with incorrect credentials.
   iii. Password recovery and session management features worked as intended, maintaining secure user sessions and enabling password resets (simulated in frontend).
   iv. The frontend registration form responded dynamically, enhancing user experience by providing immediate validation feedback.

2. **Usability Outcomes**

   i. The interface was found to be intuitive and easy to navigate by users during informal testing.
   ii. Responsive design enabled access from various devices, including mobiles and tablets.
   iii. Error messages guided users to resolve input mistakes effectively, reducing frustration.

3. **Security Outcomes**

   i. Passwords were never stored or displayed in plain text.
   ii. The frontend validation filtered out many common malformed inputs or potentially dangerous entries.
   iii. Backend (conceptual) security via password hashing and session handling ensures secure data protection.

4. **Performance Outcomes**

   i) The system processed user inputs and server responses with minimal delay, generally within 1-2 seconds depending on network conditions.
   ii) The session mechanism maintained login state accurately over the expected usage period without unintended logouts.

Challenges and Conclusion

Challenges

During the development and implementation of the user validation system, several challenges were encountered:

- ✓ Security Implementation Complexity
  Designing and implementing secure password hashing, session management, and protecting against attacks such as XSS and CSRF required careful planning and understanding of best security practices. Mistakes here could compromise user data safety.

- ✓ Balancing Usability and Security
  Ensuring strong security measures while keeping the user experience smooth was challenging. For example, strict validation and multiple authentication steps could frustrate users and lead to drop-offs.

- ✓ Input Validation and Error Handling
  Creating robust input validation on both frontend and backend to prevent invalid data and malicious inputs, while providing clear, friendly error messages demanded thorough testing.

- ✓ Cross-Browser Compatibility and Responsive UI
  Ensuring consistent behavior and appearance across different browsers and device sizes required additional effort, especially with newer CSS frameworks and JavaScript behaviors.

- ✓ Session and State Management
  Managing secure sessions, including timeout and logout flows, without compromising usability or security involved intricate backend logic.

- ✓ Testing Limitations
  Limited access to automated testing tools or comprehensive test data sometimes hindered exhaustive security and usability testing.

Conclusion

The user validation system project successfully delivered a secure, user-friendly authentication platform addressing core requirements such as registration, login, and session management. The system leveraged best security practices like password hashing and session control to protect user data effectively. Challenges around balancing security with usability were treated carefully, resulting in a responsive and intuitive user interface that provides clear feedback.

This project serves as a solid foundation for further enhancements such as multi-factor authentication, social login integration, and advanced security monitoring. The learning experience gained encompasses essential web development and security skills, preparing for more complex real-world applications.

Annexure

Program Code :-

```
<!DOCTYPE html>

<html lang="en">
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8" />
  <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0"/>
  <title>User Registration</title>
  <style>
    body { font-family: Arial, sans-serif; background: #f4f4f4; }

    .container { max-width: 400px; margin: 50px auto; background: #fff; padding:
    20px; border-radius: 8px; }

    input { width: 100%; padding: 10px; margin: 10px 0; }

    button { width: 100%; padding: 10px; background: #28a745; color: #fff;
border: none; cursor: pointer; border-radius: 4px; }

    button:hover { background: #218838; }

    .error { color: red; font-size: 0.9em; }
  </style>
</head>

<body>
  <div class="container">
    <h2>User Registration</h2>
    <form id="regForm">
      <input type="text" id="username" placeholder="Username" required />
      <input type="email" id="email" placeholder="Email" required />
      <input type="password" id="password" placeholder="Password" required
minlength="6" />
      <div id="error" class="error"></div>
      <button type="submit">Register</button>
    </form>
  </div>


  <script>
```

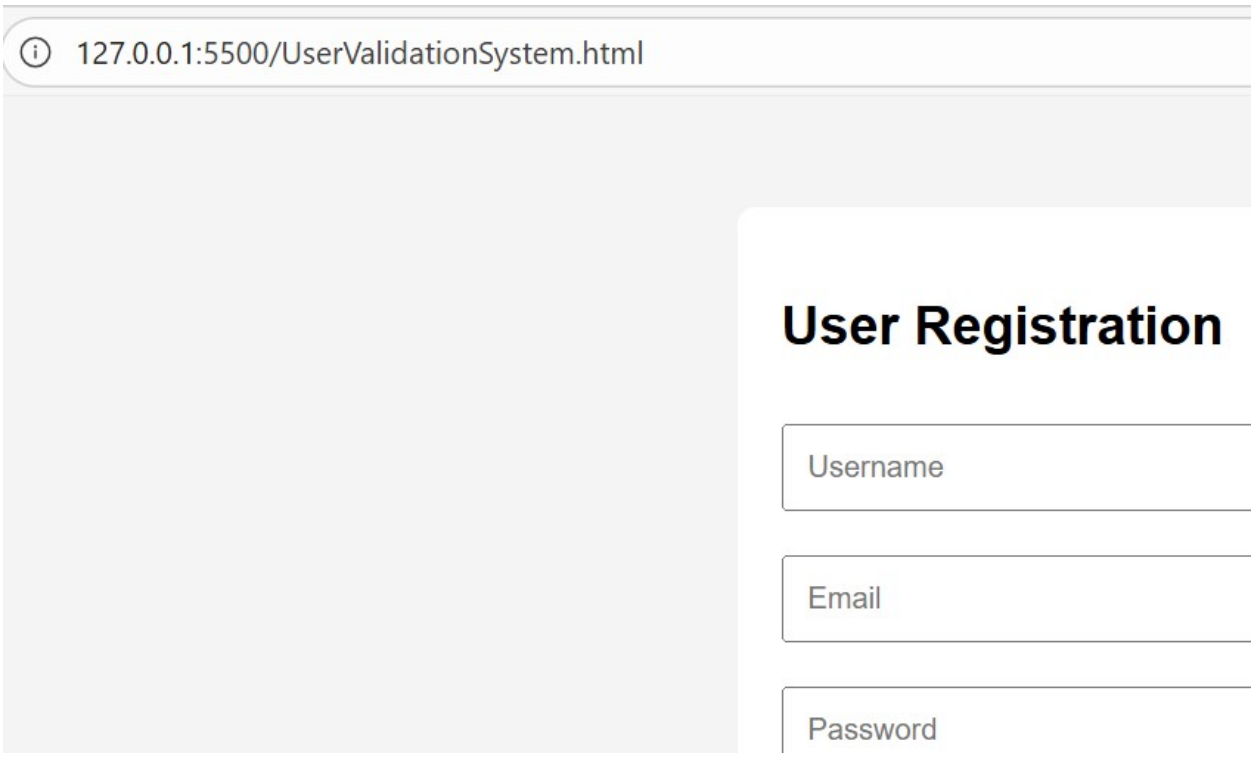
```
    const form = document.getElementById('regForm');
    const errorDiv = document.getElementById('error');

    form.addEventListener('submit', function(e) {
      e.preventDefault();
      errorDiv.textContent = '';

      const username = form.username.value.trim();
      const email = form.email.value.trim();
      const password = form.password.value;

      if (username.length < 3) {
        errorDiv.textContent = 'Username must be at least 3 characters.';
        return;
      }
      if (!email.includes('@') || !email.includes('.')) {
        errorDiv.textContent = 'Email is invalid.';
        return;
      }
      if (password.length < 6) {
        errorDiv.textContent = 'Password must be at least 6 characters.';
        return;
      }
      // Simulate successful registration
      alert('Registration successful for ' + username);
      form.reset();
    });
  </script>
</body>
</html>
```

Output :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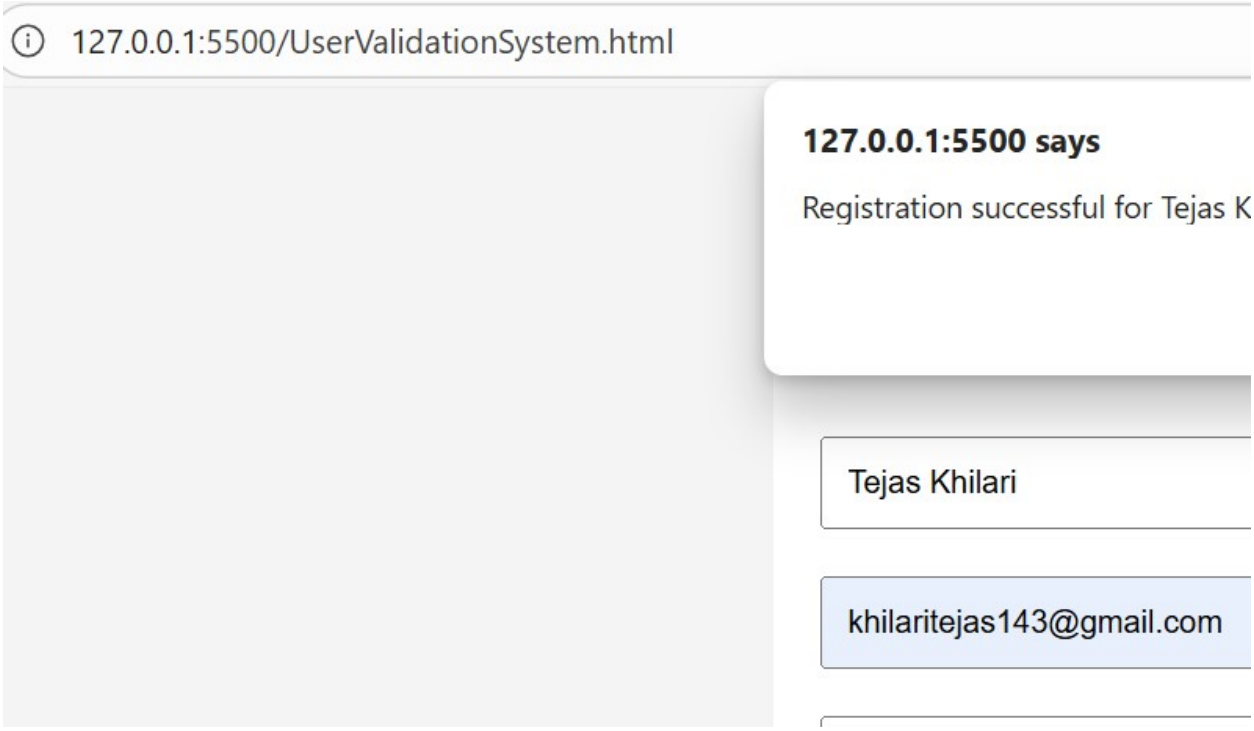
User Registration
Username
Email
Password


127.0.0.1:5500/UserValidationSystem.html
127.0.0.1:5500 says
Registration successful for Tejas K
Tejas Khilari
khilaritejas143@gmail.com